struction set for IBM PC compatibles called VCL (Virus Creation Laboratory) version 1.00 was unleashed. This set allowed generating well commented source texts of viruses in the form or assembly language texts, object modules and infected files themselves.

VCL used a standard WIMP interface—with the help of a menu system one could choose a virus type, the types of files to infect (COM or/and EXE), presence or absence of self-encryption, measures of protection from debugging, inside text strings, plus some 10 additional “effects”. Viruses could now use a standard method of infecting a file by adding their body to the end of file, or replace files with their body destroying the original content of a file, or become companion viruses. A virus creator not only had the tool but also choice.

These generator kits kept getting better and the 27th of July saw the first version of PS-MPC (Phalcon/Skism Mass-Produced Code Generator). This set used a configuration file to generate viral source code. The creator file contained description of the virus: the type of infected files (COM or EXE); resident capabilities (unlike VCL, PS-MPC could also produce resident viruses); method of installing the resident copy of the virus; self encryption capabilities; the ability to infect COMMAND.COM and lots of other useful information.

As time went by, virus construction kits got smarter, simpler and more effective. Bad news for the rest of us—practically every teenager with a bad social life and time to spare was churning viruses. Over the years there have been several hundreds of VCL and G2 based viruses and thousands PS-MPC based viruses.

In 1995, Microsoft released the revolutionary Windows 95 and antivirus companies were worried that nobody would need them anymore. The most common viruses were still boot viruses that worked on DOS, but wouldn’t replicate on Windows 95. Little did they know... Sometime the same year, macro viruses appeared. These viruses worked in the MS-Word environment. The antivirus industry would keep its job.